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Market Monitor, October 2026

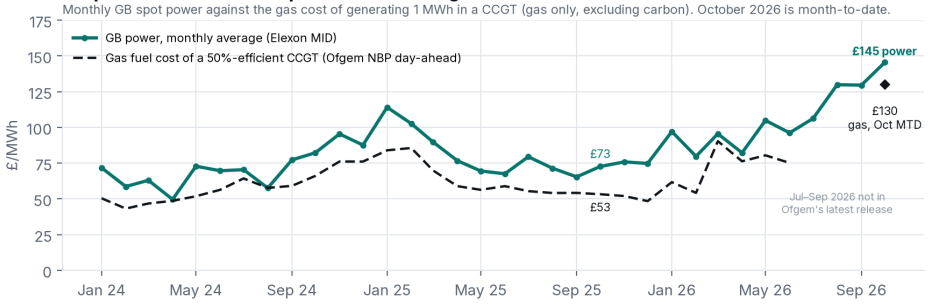
What moved in power, offshore wind and onshore renewables this month, and what is due next.

Onshore and offshore | UK and Europe

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1 The broader market: why power doubled

FIGURE 1
GB power has risen in step with the cost of gas
Monthly GB spot power against the gas cost of generating 1 MWh in a CCGT (gas only, excluding carbon). October 2026 is month-to-date.



Sources: Elexon MID (APXMIDP), to 17 Oct 2026; Ofgem Wholesale Market Indicators, NBP day-ahead monthly average, to Jun 2026; Purely Energy, NBP day-ahead month-to-date average to 16 Oct 2026. Ignis calculation: p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 ÷ 0.5. The 50% efficiency is Ofgem's central spark-spread assumption.

Gas sets the price, and gas has nearly tripled. Gas-fired plant still sets the marginal GB power price much of the time [10] [11]. NBP gas was about 217p/therm on 18 October, up 168% on a year earlier [12]. At 50% efficiency, the fuel cost of a gas plant rose from about £53 to £130/MWh over the year, roughly the whole rise in spot power (Figure 1; Ignis calculation from [1] [2] [13]).

The trigger is the Iran conflict and the Strait of Hormuz. Day-ahead gas jumped in early March as the conflict escalated [10], Hormuz disruption drew LNG cargoes away from the UK in Q2 [11], and US and Iran exchanges lifted day-ahead NBP 34% in July [14]. Stalled peace talks kept prices rising in September [15]; shipping attacks, Norwegian outages and Asian LNG at $29.61/MMBtu added more in the week to 13 October [16].

Low storage makes winter the risk. The EU started winter with storage 72% full, against 83% a year earlier, which GIE calls historically low; the UK, with little storage of its own, tracks the continental fill [2] [17] [18]. In a cold winter ENTSOG sees EU storage falling to about 11% by the end of March [17] [18]. NESO's June early view still expects GB electricity margins to be adequate [19].

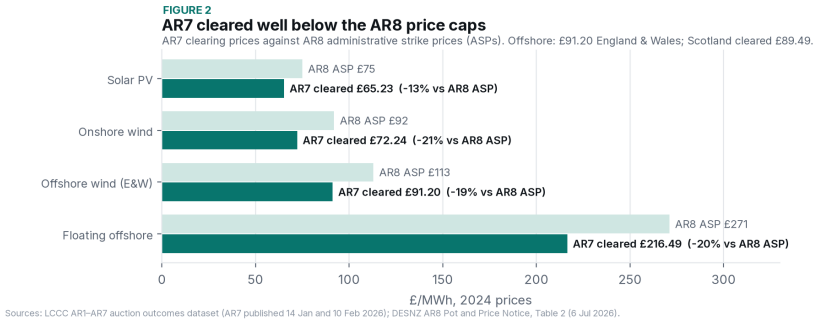
Wind drives the swings; carbon is minor. Day-ahead power rose from £130 to £160/MWh over September on a sharp fall in wind, and strong wind took next-day power to £33.89 on 9 October [16] [15]. UK ETS allowances were £65.92/t on 13 October against a 2026 reference price of £49.41/t [16] [20]; ASSUMPTION at about 0.37 tCO_2/MWh for a CCGT, that adds only £3 to £6/MWh.

Forwards put the premium in 2027. On 16 October Summer-27 power settled at £127.36/MWh, up from £83.00 at the end of July; Summer-28 was £80.69 and Summer-29 £72.80 [14] [2]. Most of these figures come from broker and consultancy notes, not exchange data.

2 European offshore wind

Two large rounds dominate this quarter, AR8 (UK) and AO10 (FR), with rule changes elsewhere and a busy month for stake sales. Fixed-bottom and floating are on different economics, so we take them separately where the sources allow.

UK: AR8 offshore against the cap



Fixed-bottom. The AR8 administrative strike price for offshore wind is £113/MWh (2024 prices) [21]. AR7 cleared 8,245 MW at £91.20 (England and Wales) and £89.49 (Scotland) [22], about 19% below that cap (Figure 2; Ignis calculation from [21] [22]). **Floating.** Floating and the new "other deepwater" category (foundations for deep water that do not technically float) bid in their own pot, Pot 4, apart from fixed-bottom in Pot 3, against a cap of £271/MWh; AR7 cleared 192.5 MW at £216.49, about 20% below it [21] [22]. DESNZ's reasoning is that deep-water wind has not yet been built at the scale needed to show which technologies are cheapest, so the rules should not block new designs [23]; ASSUMPTION a separate pot also spares them a straight price fight with mature fixed-bottom. Government will see the bids in Pots 1 to 4 before it sets each budget, but the stated test is value for money for consumers, not deliverability: it will only add budget for bids that are strong value [21]. So AR8 (UK) still awards on price, while AO10 (FR) scores proof of deliverability directly. The budget notice and Notice of Auction are due on 19 November, with results expected 15 to 17 February 2027 [5] [6].

France: AO10 bids are in

Bids for about 10 GW across 11 projects closed at noon on 12 October [3] [24]. By our arithmetic from the DGEC project list, that is about 5.25 GW of fixed-bottom (four projects) and 4.9 GW of floating (seven projects) [25]. CRE has 12 weeks to rank the offers (to 4 January 2027, 18 January at the latest) and winners are expected in February 2027 [3] [4] [26] [27]. The round sits under a €63bn, 25-year support scheme approved by the European Commission in July [28].

TYPE	SITES	WHAT MAKES IT EASIER OR HARDER	SRC
Fixed	Fécamp Grand Large, Normandy (3 × 1.35 GW); Oléron 1, South Atlantic (1.2 GW)	Fécamp: shallow, close to shore, next to Centre Manche 2 (AO8, awarded at €66/MWh). Oléron: over 60 m deep, difficult seabed, weak wind; no bids in AO7	[25] [29] [30]
Floating	Brittany: Bretagne Nord Ouest (1.2 GW), Bretagne Sud 2 (0.5 GW). Mediterranean: Golfe du Lion Centre (1.1 GW plus 2 × 550 MW), Narbonnaise Sud Hérault 2, Golfe de Fos 2 (0.5 GW each)	Brittany: harsher sites that may need drilled anchors. Mediterranean: strong wind, soft seabed suited to drag anchors, 90 to 95 m depth	[25] [29]

Rules that decide it. Offers are marked out of 100: price 70, robustness of the contractual and financial set-up 18, carbon footprint 6, European content 6, and a bid below 11 of the 18 robustness points is eliminated [31]. There is no cap per project; the target is a capacity-weighted average of €100/MWh across all winners, and if it is exceeded CRE drops projects, latest grid dates and highest prices first [31] [32]. ASSUMPTION Cheap fixed-bottom bids make room for floating. Bidders need at least 500 MW of offshore wind and €1bn of offshore investment, so newcomers need a partner [31]. On floating appetite, Spinergie estimates around 330 floaters for the tender [29], and TotalEnergies' chief executive has said the company is no longer interested in floating wind [33]. ASSUMPTION For bidders, the time to February is when partner governance, the first 90 days after award, supply-chain slots and the financing plan get

prepared. I went through the scoring in detail in Signal Issue 1, AO10 bids submitted: why proof, not price, will decide France's offshore wind round: read it on ignisleadership.com.

The wider European picture

Beyond AR8 (UK) and AO10 (FR), little is being awarded this quarter; most of the movement is in rules. Germany's cabinet adopted a draft amendment to its offshore wind act on 2 September: tenders run subsidy-free first, with a two-sided CfD if no bids come in, 2,000 to 4,800 MW a year and a 35-year operating period; it is not yet law [34] [35]. The Netherlands, which has awarded offshore wind without subsidy since 2018, is paying support again after its 1 GW Nederwiek I-A tender drew no bids in October 2025 [36] [37]. For the 2 GW IJmuiden Ver Gamma sites it offers a temporary, SDE++-style subsidy that tops up revenue when power prices fall below the winning bid; in June the maximum bid was raised from €104 and €103/MWh to €117 (Gamma-A) and €116/MWh (Gamma-B), because a proposed grid charge on producers adds cost uncertainty [38] [39] [40]. Gamma-A bids run from 26 November to 10 December, with a subsidy-free auction alongside, and two-sided CfDs are planned for later rounds [39] [41]. Belgium is relaunching its first Princess Elisabeth Zone tender, cancelled in July 2025, with one two-sided CfD on all output and no maximum strike price: the cap is removed, not raised or lowered, because the government judged a preset cap could deter bidders; the lowest strike price wins [42] [43] [44]. The relaunch still needs EU state-aid approval [45]. For reference, Denmark's August tender awarded 1.8 GW to Vattenfall at €67.42 and €72.50/MWh under two-sided CfDs [34] [46]. In finance, Skyborn signed €2.2bn of project finance for the 975 MW Gennaker farm in the German Baltic, backed by corporate PPAs with Amazon (600 MW) and Uniper (100 MW) [34].

DATE	DEAL	DETAIL	SRC
8 Oct	RWE completes sale of its 33.33% of Five Estuaries (UK, fixed) to EDF	EDF takes over as lead developer; RWE to reinvest in its consented offshore projects	7
13 Oct	CIP buys 25% of Five Estuaries	Up to 1,080 MW, from the Macquarie-led consortium	47
12 Oct	Ørsted buys back 49.9% of Gunfleet Sands 1 & 2 (UK, operating)	172 MW, about £15m; closing expected in November; late-life options including extension	8
1 Oct	EWE, RWE and Vattenfall sell alpha ventus (Germany, operating) to Ocean Breeze Energy	60 MW, Germany's first offshore farm; Macquarie-owned buyer; closing expected Q4 2026	48 49

ASSUMPTION The pattern: utilities recycling capital out of development stakes, and owners taking full control of operating farms to extend their life. We found no portfolio swaps in the period.

3 UK onshore: the last mile to financial close

For onshore wind, solar and BESS developers becoming IPPs, the market move lands on four commercial calls at once.

Route to market: one sealed bid against a fixed cap. The AR8 caps are £75/MWh for solar and £92 for onshore wind (2024 prices); AR7 cleared at £65.23 and £72.24, 13% and 21% below them (Figure 2) [21] [22]. The budget notice and Notice of Auction are due on 19 November, and results are expected 15 to 17 February 2027 [5] [6].

What "Pots 1 to 4 versus Pot 5" means. AR8 sorts technologies into five pots, each with its own budget: Pot 1 is solar (over 5 MW); Pot 2 is onshore wind and remote island wind (over 5 MW); Pot 3 is offshore wind; Pot 4 is floating and other deep-water offshore wind; Pot 5 is everything else, such as tidal stream, wave, geothermal, hydro, anaerobic digestion, landfill and sewage gas, and biomass or energy from waste with CHP [21]. In Pots 1 to 4 each project may submit only one sealed bid: one strike price, one capacity and one set of target dates (Rules 13.1 and 13.3) [50]. In Pot 5 a project may submit up to four "flexible bids" with different capacities or delivery dates, and the auction can fall back on a smaller or later variant if the first does not fit the budget (Rule 13.7) [50]. Pots 1 to 4 are also the pots where Government sees the anonymised bids that do not fit the budget; it will only add budget for bids it judges strong value for money, and it weighs technologies against each other, so more budget for one pot may mean less for another [21].
ASSUMPTION For a solar or onshore wind developer this means one shot: capacity, delivery year and price have to be settled before bidding, and a bid priced just outside the budget depends on Government rating it good value against offshore and other onshore bids.

How AR8 differs from earlier rounds. Flexible bids are not new: since the first round in 2014, applicants could submit alternative bids with a smaller capacity or a later delivery date, up to ten then and up to four by AR7 [51] [52]. AR7 removed them for fixed-bottom offshore wind only, and it was also the first round in which Government looked at anonymised bids that did not fit the budget, again for fixed-bottom offshore only [52] [53]. AR8 extends both rules to every technology in Pots 1 to 4: solar, onshore and remote island wind, and floating and deep-water offshore now get a single sealed bid with one price, one capacity (no more than the figure in the application) and one set of target dates, and Government sees the bids that fall outside the budget before deciding whether to add money [21] [50] [54].

Grid: Gate 2 in plain words

What it is. Connections reform replaced "first come, first served" with a queue re-ordered on readiness (checked against evidence such as land rights and the planning route) and on strategic alignment with the Government's Clean Power 2030 plan [55] [56]. A project that passes gets **Gate 2**: an offer with a confirmed connection date, point of connection, works and cost. A project that does not gets **Gate 1**: its old dates become indicative only, any cash security is refunded, and it can reapply in a later window [55]. Gate 2 projects are split by when the plan needs them: **Phase 1** for connections needed in 2026 to 2030, **Phase 2** for 2031 to 2035 [55]. Each phase comes in two steps: NESO issues transmission offers first (projects on the transmission network and large projects on local networks), then the distribution network operators (DNOs, such as NGED) issue offers to smaller projects on their networks, which need NESO's transmission information first [57] [9].

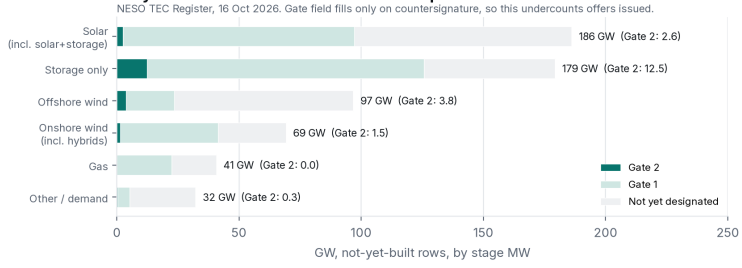
By 31 Oct 2026	By 30 Nov 2026	By 31 Jan 2027	By 31 Mar 2027
Phase 1 transmission offers NESO; projects needed by 2030. About 62 offers still to go	**Phase 1 distribution offers** DNOs, in batches by grid supply point; projects needed by 2030	**Phase 2 transmission offers** NESO; projects needed 2031 to 2035	**Phase 2 distribution offers** DNOs; projects needed 2031 to 2035

Deadlines set or agreed by Ofgem [57] [58].

What happens on 31 October. It is NESO's deadline for the last **Phase 1 transmission offers**, about 62 of them. The original deadline was 30 September; Ofgem extended it because National Grid Electricity Transmission (NGET, the transmission owner in England and Wales) was late with the engineering inputs NESO needs, and about 25 projects asked to receive their offer later [57]. Phase 2 and distribution deadlines did not move [57]. The NGED dates are separate: they are its Phase 1 distribution batches, each group of grid supply points with its own issue date and acceptance deadline [9].

What the developer must do after an offer lands. For a NESO Gate 2 offer: sign within 90 days, then place securities within 30 days of signing; the first payment can be anything from zero to several million pounds, depending on how much the network owner is spending, and is updated every six months [55]. For an NGED distribution offer: accept by the batch deadline, about six weeks after issue (Batch 5 was issued on 14 September, with acceptance by 26 October) [9]; other DNOs set their own timelines [55]. If a Gate 2 offer lapses, NESO must issue a residual Gate 1 offer within 6 weeks [58]. Once signed, the agreement carries milestones worked back from the connection date, starting with beginning consents (M1), securing consents (M2) and securing land rights (M3); a project that misses the early milestones is terminated unless an exception applies [59]. Cutting the capacity declared at application triggers cancellation charges [55].

FIGURE 3
Only 20.8 GW of a 604 GW transmission queue carries a Gate 2 label
NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026. Gate field fills only on countersignature, so this undercounts offers issued.



Source: NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026 (CSV); Ignis calculation: rows not marked Built, summed MW Increase/Decrease; hybrids classed by first renewable technology.

What Figure 3 shows. Of the 604 GW in the transmission queue not yet built, 20.8 GW carries a Gate 2 label, about 295 GW Gate 1, and about 288 GW is "not yet designated", our label for rows whose Gate field is still blank (Ignis

calculation from the 16 October TEC Register [60]). The field only fills once an agreement is countersigned, so Gate 2 looks small partly because offers are still being issued and signed: about four projects a week have gained the label since 25 August [61]. By 10 June, NESO and the DNOs had issued Gate 2 offers to 713 projects (37 GW), including distribution offers the register does not carry [61]. By technology, solar (including solar with storage, 186 GW) and storage only (179 GW) are the largest; storage has the most in Gate 1 (113 GW) and in Gate 2 (12.5 GW); onshore wind including hybrids is 69 GW, 1.5 GW of it at Gate 2; offshore wind is 97 GW, three quarters not yet designated [60]. ASSUMPTION A blank or Gate 1 row is not a verdict on a project; the offer letter is what counts.

Contracted revenue before capital. October's GB deals were built on contracted or optimised revenue. ASSUMPTION Lenders and equity price BESS on the quality of its floor or toll as much as on the project; tolls priced off October's volatility need testing against a calmer 2028 curve.

DATE	DEAL	DETAIL	SRC
2 Oct	CIP: FID on Kilmarnock South BESS	350 MW / 1,400 MWh; more than €270m; long-term Shell optimisation agreement	62
Oct	Econergy's Dalmarnock BESS connects	40 MW / 120 MWh; about £21m Santander debt; 10-year EDF floor	63
25 Sep	Revera: financial close on Hunterston BESS	400 MW / 800 MWh; BP toll and Danske Commodities floor	64
14 Oct	Ares minority stake in Statera's 1.9 GW portfolio	Includes Carrington Storage (680 MW) and Thurrock (750 MW); terms not disclosed	65
14 Oct	ORIT conditionally buys Barnsdale Solar Park	55 MWp, AR5 CfD to 2041; about £34.6m (about £0.63m/MWp, Ignis calculation)	66
15 Oct	Greencoat UK Wind takes a 96.4 MW onshore portfolio to 100%	Buys EDF Invest's 20%; joint repowering arrangement	67

Procurement: supply prices are soft. Rotterdam warehouse prices for 450 to 475 W TOPCon modules fell about 5.8% between 3 July and 25 September, and some hundred-megawatt projects for 2027 delivery still won discounts [68]; prices stayed under pressure in mid-October [69]. China LFP storage cell prices eased in the week to 14 October while system prices held flat, as integrators have not yet passed lower cell costs through [70]. These are China and European warehouse prices, not GB delivered EPC prices. ASSUMPTION A refreshed EPC or supply quote can move a walk-away price as much as the power curve does. A fuller procurement watch, covering GB EPC pricing and grid-equipment lead times, starts in November.

Consents. Green Hill (up to 500 MW solar with storage) and Steeple Renewables (about 450 MW solar, 150 MW BESS) won DCOs on 8 and 9 October [71] [72]; Botley West's decision is due on 10 November after an extension [73]; East Cambridgeshire District Council voted to oppose Vattenfall's Chatteris (up to 126 MW) and Redmere (up to 303 MW) wind farms, though it is not the decision-maker; both are at pre-application, with DCO applications expected in July 2027 [74] [75] [76]. ASSUMPTION The risk is local opposition and slippage, not refusal.

4 What is due, and when

European offshore wind

DATE	WHAT IS DUE	WHO IT TOUCHES	WHAT'S HAPPENING	SRC
19 Nov	AR8 (UK) budget notice and Notice of Auction	Pot 3 (offshore) and Pot 4 (floating and deep-water)	Budgets become known; sealed bids follow	5 6 21
26 Nov to 10 Dec	IJmuiden Ver Gamma-A (NL) bid window	1 GW site bidders	Subsidy tender, maximum €117/MWh	41
4 Jan 2027 (18 Jan latest)	CRE ranking of AO10 (FR) offers	AO10 bidders	Winners expected in February	3
15 to 17 Feb 2027	AR8 (UK) results expected	AR8 applicants	Same window as AO10 (FR) awards	5 6

UK onshore

DATE	WHAT IS DUE	WHO IT TOUCHES	WHAT'S HAPPENING	SRC
26 Oct, 2, 9, 16 and 23 Nov	Phase 1 distribution offers: NGED acceptance deadlines, Batches 5 to 9	Projects at those grid supply points	Accept, or the offer lapses and a residual Gate 1 offer follows within 6 weeks	9 58
31 Oct	Phase 1 transmission offers	About 62 transmission and large projects	NESO's extended deadline; 90 days to sign	57 55
10 Nov	Botley West DCO decision deadline	Large solar	A read on consent timelines	73
19 Nov	AR8 (UK) budget notice and Notice of Auction	Pot 1 (solar) and Pot 2 (onshore wind)	Budgets become known; sealed bids follow	5 6 21
20 Nov	EU and UK summit, carbon market linking on the table	Gas-set power prices	A link would move UK ETS prices	16
20 and 27 Nov	Phase 1 distribution offers: NGED Batches 10 and 11 issued	Projects at those grid supply points	Accept by 28 Dec and 4 Jan	9
30 Nov	Phase 1 distribution offers complete	All DNO-connected Phase 1 projects	Last Phase 1 offers out	57
"Later in autumn"	Ofgem LDES Window 1 final decision	Shortlisted storage projects		77
31 Jan 2027	Phase 2 transmission offers	Projects needed 2031 to 2035	NESO's deadline; 90 days to sign	57 55
15 to 17 Feb 2027	AR8 (UK) results expected	AR8 applicants		5 6
March 2027	Capacity Market auctions (T-1 and T-4)	BESS and flexible plant		78
31 Mar 2027	Phase 2 distribution offers complete	DNO-connected Phase 2 projects	Last Gate 2 offers of this round	57

If you need support

Consulting is what I do. I help developers grow their pipeline and take projects to financial close: in offshore wind, winning the right to develop and getting off to a fast start after award; onshore, the commercial work from bid and tender to route to market and financial close.

Alongside that, I've been building an agentic workflow to help me move projects along: AI agents that read and compare project documents, keep track of sources and assumptions, and hold the decision trail, with me checking the work and your team making the calls. Over time it captures the intelligence from each project into a system you keep, so the next one starts further ahead. It is something I am building and use in my own work, not a finished product.

If one of the things in this monitor is on your desk and you need support, let's have a conversation.

Let's talk

Book a 30-minute call

Or write to me at yorik@ignisleadership.com or use the contact page

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Method and data notes

Data checked: market data 16 to 18 October 2026; storage, offshore and procurement items 17 to 20 October 2026. **Wholesale:** simple average of half-hourly Elexon APXMIDP prices with non-zero volume, 1 January 2024 to 17 October 2026; October is month-to-date. **Gas cost of power (Figure 1):** NBP p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 = £/MWh of gas, ÷ 0.5 for a 50%-efficient CCGT (Ofgem's central spark-spread assumption) [13]; gas only. October uses Purely Energy's day-ahead average to 16 October; Ofgem's series ends in June 2026. **Gas storage:** GIE's official EU figure for 1 October [17]; mid-October UK figures disagree between sources, so we quote none. **TEC Register:** rows not marked Built, summed "MW Increase / Decrease". **CfD prices:** AR7 and AR8 in 2024 prices. **AO10:** rules and estimates as summarised in Signal Issue 1 (sources checked 17 October 2026). **European offshore deals:** announcements from 1 to 20 October 2026; the Danish award (4 August) is included for reference only.

Not verified UNVERIFIED: Gate 2 Phase 1 capacity still to be issued. LDES final decision timing. NESO's full Winter Outlook 2026/27, due in October: not found, so we rely on the June early view [19].

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